

# Stillpoint Therapy

Counselling for adults · Lewes and online · Michael Deane

PREPARED BY

Alexander Watson Studio

STAGE

Before website design

STATUS

For your review

DATE

September 2026

# Decided here, before anything is designed.

A Practice Clarity Blueprint settles the direction of your practice before design begins: how the practice is described, who the site speaks to most directly, what it says first, how it sounds, how it looks, and what it must contain. Once agreed, the design stage builds on these decisions instead of reopening them.

Read it as a description of your practice that you are entitled to correct. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where the wording is right but not yours, say that as well — the same kind of correction, and just as useful.

| UNDERSTANDING THE PRACTICE      | CREATIVE RECOMMENDATION    | SUMMARY AND APPROVAL                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 Practice at a glance         | 07 Brand direction         | 13 Practice Clarity Snapshot                                                                                                                                        |
| 02 Professional identity        | 08 Logo and identity       | 14 Approval and next step                                                                                                                                           |
| 03 Philosophy of practice       | 09 Colour                  |                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 04 The people you want to reach | 10 Typography              | Three decisions here are open rather than settled, and are marked where they occur: the central proposition, the primary message, and whether you are photographed. |
| 05 Messaging and voice          | 11 Photography and imagery |                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 06 Intended client experience   | 12 Website translation     |                                                                                                                                                                     |

TO CONFIRM BEFORE PUBLICATION

Qualification and awarding body · Register and membership number · Insurer · Supervision arrangement · The online platform · The services and numbers the urgent-help note should name. These are deliberately blank, and nothing of this kind appears on the website until you supply it.

Portfolio note — Stillpoint Therapy and Michael Deane are a fictional practice created by Alexander Watson Studio to demonstrate the Practice Clarity Blueprint. Facts described as established are established within that concept; no qualification, registration, membership or clinical claim here belongs to a real practitioner. This note appears only in portfolio editions.

HOW TO READ IT

- **Established.** Facts you have given us. Nothing factual has been assumed; anything not yet established is listed below rather than filled in.
- **Interpretation.** Our reading of what those facts imply. Most of the first six sections are interpretation, and correcting it is the point of your review.
- **Recommendation.** Proposals for the identity and the website. Approve, adjust or refuse them.

Each page is marked at the top. The first six sections set out our understanding of the practice; the next six turn it into creative recommendations.

# An hour, and somewhere to put something down.

Somewhere to stop for a while.

YOUR OWN LINE FOR IT · ESTABLISHED

## THE PRACTITIONER

Eighteen years in practice, eleven of them in hospice and bereavement services. Adults, individually. In Lewes Tuesday to Thursday, online Monday and Friday.

## THE PEOPLE

Adults who are managing — working, answering messages, doing what needs doing — and carrying something that has run out of anywhere to be said.

## THE CENTRAL CONCERN

Not crisis. The absence of anywhere ordinary to say a thing properly, more than once, to someone who is not frightened of it.

## THE PROPOSITION, REVISED · OPEN DECISION

The practice has been described to us as a *place*, not a *process* — an hour and a room rather than a method or an outcome. We would set that wording aside. Two of your five working days are online, so the room is not the constant; and *place* pulls the website towards the premises, which are modest and not the point.

What survives the edit is the asymmetry underneath it. You are blunt about how bad things are; what you make ordinary is not the difficulty but the therapy.

**A regular, unremarkable hour in which something that has become unsayable everywhere else can be put down and said properly.**

This is the sentence the website is built on. It is not homepage copy, and it is the first thing to disagree with if it is wrong.

**The feeling to create.** Not calm — calm is a by-product, and promising it would be an instruction. The operative feeling is that nothing is being asked of you yet.

## THE PRACTICAL FACTS · ESTABLISHED

|                    |                                                     |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Fee                | £70                                                 |
| Reduced places     | £45, no form and no means test                      |
| Session            | 55 minutes, weekly, same time                       |
| Where and when     | Lewes Tuesday to Thursday, online Monday and Friday |
| First conversation | Free, twenty minutes                                |
| Reply              | Within two working days                             |
| Cancellation       | 48 hours' notice                                    |
| Access             | Second floor, no lift                               |

Experienced, and  
unwilling to perform it.

A counsellor who treats time and attention as the working materials, and who has taken out of the hour everything that would ask a client to perform.

IDENTITY STATEMENT · INTERPRETATION

Deflationary about the craft

You describe the hospice as having taught you that the work takes far less cleverness and far more patience than you assumed, and call the evidence for the therapeutic relationship the least glamorous finding in the field. The expertise is real. You do not stage it.

Quiet by method, not by temperament

Fewer questions than people expect, asked because you have not understood rather than to steer, and a silence you will not fill unless the client wants it filled. You describe this as a decision about who sets the pace, which is why the site should not style it as serenity.

Direct, and correctable

You name avoidance, and in the same sentence give the client the right to tell you that you have it wrong. The site should carry that invitation in your own words.

Unfrightened by the material

Eleven years in hospice and bereavement services, and writing that goes where sympathy cards do not: relief, anger, a death nobody counted, grieving someone you did not entirely like. It is what your account of change rests on.

Unhurried, and says so

You offer time as the resource other settings rarely can: talking about the person who died for longer than anyone has allowed, and slowing a decision down before examining it. A practical fact about the hour, not a mood.

Bounded in public

No couples, families or children. No assessment or diagnosis, no reports for courts, employers or insurers, not an emergency service, second floor and no lift. Naming your limits reads to us as a trust device rather than a disclaimer, and it belongs in the body of the site.

TESTED AND SET ASIDE

**Warm** and **empathetic** — expected of competent counselling, claimed nowhere by you, and useless as a differentiator. **Passive** — wrong; you interrupt avoidance. **Austere** — wrong; the writing is dry rather than cold, and often funny.

# The loss does not shrink. The carrying might.

Our reading of the position you described to us. It decides what the website is organised around, so it is worth disagreeing with if we have it wrong.

You make an unusually small claim about what therapy does. Not recovery, not closure, not a stage completed — only that what tends to change is how much of a life the thing takes to carry. We would let the site say that and claim nothing larger.

Underneath it sits a working assumption rather than a theory: that a difficulty gets heavier when there is nowhere to put it. You describe sealing something off as costing energy that cannot be spared, and speech — repeated, to someone unfrightened by it — as what can change the weight. That is your position rather than a general account, and the site should hold it at that strength.

You refuse the medical frame in the same breath. Grief is not an illness, and neither is realising at fifty-two that you no longer recognise the life you built. You treat these as problems of meaning, which is why your training can be explained in a paragraph and then left alone.

*What tends to change is not the size of the loss but how much of your life it takes to carry.*

IN YOUR OWN WORDS · ESTABLISHED

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## WHAT FOLLOWS FROM IT

- Nothing to do between sessions. No exercises, no worksheets, no rating a mood out of ten. The hour is for talking.
- No stages and no closure, on the stated grounds that being given a schedule for grief tends to make people feel they are doing it incorrectly.
- No diagnosis, assessment or reports, and no health insurance — insurers require a diagnosis, session limits and reports, none of which fit the way you work.
- You treat the relationship, rather than the model, as what does most of the work — so you make it examinable: contradiction invited, the work reviewed aloud, *this isn't working* treated as usable information.
- Nobody has to arrive with an explanation. Not being able to say what it is about is a normal starting position, not a reason to wait.

# Managing, and out of anywhere to say it.

Our reading of who the website should speak to most directly. It is a question of emphasis in the writing, not a limit on who you will see or a clinical boundary.

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## VISIBLE FROM OUTSIDE

Full functioning. Work, messages, the school run, the estate paperwork. Nobody is worried about them. Adults, a lot of them in their forties, fifties and sixties, and more than half of them men.

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## HAPPENING INSIDE

Something has ended, accumulated, arrived late, or never got said: a death, a marriage that has gone silent, the sense of living a life that belongs to somebody else.

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## WHY THE ORDINARY PLACES RAN OUT

You put it as: people are kind for about a month. The material repeats, and they will not raise it a fifth time. Some of it is socially inadmissible. Sometimes the people they would tell are the subject.

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## WHAT THEY HOPE FOR

Modest and specific. To say the thing properly, once, to someone who will not flinch. To understand what happened. To stop being the only one holding it. Not transformation, which you do not offer.

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## TWO THINGS THEY ARE WARY OF

### **Being asked to perform**

The stated suspicion is that therapy might involve producing an emotion on demand. Copy that reaches for feeling early confirms it.

### **Being made into a patient**

They have a situation, not a condition. A page that sorts them into presenting problems does the thing they came here to avoid.

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## THE THIRD DOOR · INTERPRETATION

Bereavement and life changes are circumstances. The third route — for people to whom therapy itself is unfamiliar — is not a circumstance at all. It is an objection, and it should be given a page and a permanent place in the navigation.

For a reader who has been deciding for somewhere between six months and nine years, unfamiliarity is the barrier the website has to answer. An FAQ would make it a footnote.

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The two circumstances are doors, not a definition. Described as counselling for bereavement and life changes, the practice loses what section 01 identifies as its actual organising idea.

# Said plainly, and then left alone.

PRIMARY MESSAGE · OPEN DECISION

Somewhere to stop for a while — without a diagnosis, a crisis, or a reason you can put into words.

You do not have to become a different kind of person, or explain yourself first, to use this.

Two candidates, without a preference. The first names what is on offer; the second removes what the reader assumes is required. Yours is the second.

NOTHING IS REQUIRED IN ADVANCE

Stated once, explicitly, next to the action rather than buried in reassurance — and as permission rather than encouragement.

THE PRACTICAL FACTS ARE PUBLISHED

Fee, address, days, cancellation terms, what you write down and who could ever see it. Published rather than available on request, so nobody has to ask what it costs.

DIFFICULTY IS DESCRIBED ACCURATELY

Relief and anger after a death, a grief with no social permission attached, a life that stopped fitting. The register stays exact. What you make ordinary is the therapy, never the difficulty.

HOW IT SHOULD SOUND

Plain, specific, unhurried, dry. Ordinary nouns and verbs, no register above the reader's, real numbers wherever a number will do. Second person used sparingly and almost only for practical instruction, so a reader recognises themselves without being addressed.

The characteristic move is to make an observation and then decline to interpret it — *people are kind for about a month*, and no consolation follows. Keep it.

Your writing is also exactly and unshowily funny, never at the reader's expense. It should survive editing.

EMBRACE

- Plain description of situations
- Numbers stated openly
- Named limits and refusals
- Observations left uninterpreted
- The reader's own scepticism, in their words

AVOID

- Inner child, journey, holding space
- Safe space, healing, transformation
- Stages, closure, any timetable for grief
- Reassurance before it is earned
- Any sentence arguing for having therapy

One caution. The plainness is a manner, not a subject. Writing about how plain the practice is would be the same mistake as writing about how calm it is.

# Nothing is being asked of you yet.

What a first visitor should feel, understand, be able to trust, and be able to do — in that order, because it is the order they ask in.

FEEL

Unhurried and unobserved. Not required to perform, or to have an emotion ready. Taken seriously without being turned into a patient. Free to stop reading, or to stop after one conversation.

UNDERSTAND

What you are like to sit with, before what therapy is. What an hour actually contains, what it costs, where it happens, and whether this kind of work applies to them at all.

TRUST

Built by disclosure rather than assertion. Experience stated once and flatly. Registration, supervision, insurance and the BACP framework given as checkable facts once supplied. Fees in a table. The exceptions to confidentiality listed in full, including the unflattering ones.

DO

Arrange a first conversation — never *start therapy*. Twenty free minutes whose stated purpose is working out whether to meet, with no requirement to explain the problem first.

THE ARC

Arrival

One line, three sentences, and the fee. The practical questions answered before any emotional material appears.

Recognition

Situations written without an owner, so the reader can find themselves without being addressed.

Practical certainty

What the hour contains, what it costs, who it is not for, and where to go instead — named.

Contact

A short form with *two lines is enough* beside it, and what happens next described before it is sent.

WHY THE EXIT IS BLESSED · INTERPRETATION

Someone who has been deciding for years is weighing commitment as much as information. So the first step is made small and explicitly reversible, and stopping there is described as a perfectly good outcome. A site that treats the enquiry as the start of a commitment risks losing this reader at the last screen.

STATED AS CONTENT, NOT SMALL PRINT

Second floor, no lift · £70, and £45 places with no means test · 48 hours' notice · Replies may take two working days · What this practice will not do · Where to go instead, named — including services that would cost nothing

# The page should not fill the silence.

You describe a specific manner: you do not steer, you do not ask anyone to perform, and you volunteer the awkward facts before they are discovered. The identity's job is to behave that way in another medium, so the site is consistent with the hour rather than an advertisement for it.

That produces subtraction as a working method. Cards, badges, testimonials, prompts and pop-ups all fail the test at the foot of this page — here, rather than everywhere.

Warmth is not designed in. We would expect it to arrive through the writing and the exactness of the practical information, rather than through colour or shape.

**What must survive any future redesign:** one accent, used only for actions and the identity rule; a hierarchy that never shouts; practical facts published as content; and a first step that stays reversible.

*If an element asks the reader for something the room would not, it goes.*

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

## TWO CANDIDATE IDEAS, ONE KEPT

An editorial object rather than a therapy website describes the result but decides nothing. The rule we are keeping is that the interface behaves the way you say you behave; the editorial character follows from it.

### WHAT IT CARRIES

- Space used as a claim about manner
- Exactness in every number
- One idea, held all the way through
- Facts given the same weight as feeling
- Warmth carried by the writing, not the styling

### WHAT IT AVOIDS

- Sage, oat and blush palettes; gradients
- Rounded cards, soft shadows, icon sets
- Ripples, pebbles, enso circles, still water
- Stock photography of calm
- Anything that reads as a wellness brand

**The name is not a brief.** Stillpoint invites a visual pun. Nothing in the identity should illustrate stillness; the restraint has to come from the manner, or it is decoration.

# A name, on the same rule as everything else.

We recommend no symbol. A symbol would add apparatus this identity does not need, and most marks available to this name would illustrate stillness — a pause, a ripple, a point. The name and the rule already carry the restraint.

So the identity is a nameplate: the name set in the text face, at text weight, sitting on the same hairline rule that separates every section of the site. The name is given no more apparatus than a section label.

## CONSTRUCTION

- The rule is exactly the width of the name, never wider
- Clear space of one cap height on all four sides
- Descriptor in the same serif, small and letterspaced — never a strapline
- Minimum width 84px; below that the rule is dropped and the name stands alone
- Exact tracking, rule weight and optical spacing are settled in the build, not here

## MISUSE

Never outlined, rotated, boxed or set over a photograph · never set in rust, which belongs to actions · never extended so the rule runs past the name · never all capitals · never paired with a symbol added later

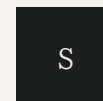
## PRIMARY LOCKUP

### Stillpoint

Site header, correspondence, print. The rule is the site's own divider, used once at full name width.

## SMALL USE AND FAVICON

### Stillpoint



At favicon size the identity reduces to one letter on ink. This is a compromise, not a mark, and it appears nowhere else.

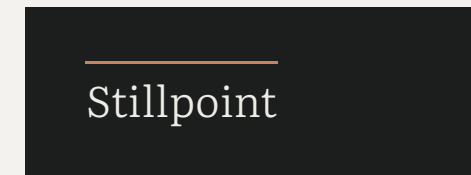
## WITH DESCRIPTOR

### Stillpoint

COUNSELLING · LEWES

Footer and anywhere the practice is unfamiliar. Never a second typeface, never a strapline in place of the descriptor.

## ON INK

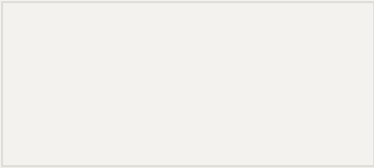


The rule takes the lifted rust so it holds the same weight it has on paper.

# Colour says what you can do, not what to feel.

You do not tell anyone how a thing is supposed to feel. A palette carrying mood would lean that way for you.

WHY THE PALETTE IS THIS SMALL



Paper

#F3F2EE

THE PAGE

A warm off-white with no colour cast. The ground for everything that is read, and most of what a visitor sees.



Ink

#1B1E1C

TYPE AND DIRECT ADDRESS

All primary type on paper, and the full-bleed ground where the practice speaks directly. A dark that is neither black nor navy.

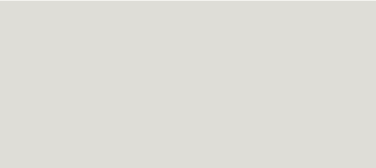


Stone

#63665F

SECONDARY

Labels, captions, dates, practical notes. Anything that names something rather than saying it. Never body copy.



Fog

#DEDDDD

RULES ONLY

One weight, hairline. Divides sections and rows, and draws a swatch edge. Never a fill, never type, never a container ruled around content.



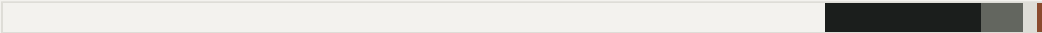
Rust

#8A4A2E / #C4855F on ink

ACTIONS

Links, focus states, the identity rule, and nothing else. Never a heading, never a background, never an emphasis on a feeling word.

PROPORTION ON ANY SCREEN



Paper 79 Ink 15 Stone 4 Fog 1.4 Rust 0.6. Ink is spent on direct address only — at most one field per page, and several pages with none, so it never becomes a rhythm.

CONTRAST AND DARK FIELDS

Ink on paper 15.0:1 · Stone on paper 5.2:1 · Rust on paper 6.0:1 · Paper on ink 14.2:1 · Lifted rust on ink 5.5:1. All clear AA for body text, and stone is never used below 14px. Rust is never the only signal that something is a link — it carries an underline too, so the palette does not have to be seen in colour to work.

**Not in the system.** No second accent. No sage, oat, blush or terracotta. No tinted section grounds. No gradient, no coloured overlay on a photograph, and no state colour for success or error beyond the rust and the ink.

# One voice, so one typeface.

We tested a second face for facts and rejected it. A practice with two registers needs two typefaces; yours has a single register, in which the fee and the sentence about grief are said in the same tone by the same person. Splitting them would draw a line you do not draw.

HIERARCHY

|                 |                              |                                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| DISPLAY         | Light 300 · 34px             | Somewhere to stop                            |
| SECTION         | Regular 400 · 24px           | What an hour contains                        |
| BODY            | Regular 400 · 18px / 1.65    | Most people who come here are not in crisis. |
| QUOTED SPEECH   | Light italic 300 · 21px      | <i>Two lines is enough.</i>                  |
| LABEL           | Semibold 600 · 14px, +0.17em | HOW IT WORKS                                 |
| LEDGER AND DATA | Regular 400 · 16px, tabular  | £70 · 55 minutes · Tuesday to Thursday       |

SOURCE SERIF 4 · THE WHOLE SYSTEM

# Aa Stillpoint

The face already in use, and we would keep it. A serif drawn for reading on screens: generous x-height, open counters, sturdy at small sizes, unfashionable enough not to date. Weights 300, 400 and 600 only. Tabular figures throughout, so £70, 55 minutes and 48 hours line up wherever they appear.

WHY THE HIERARCHY IS COMPRESSED

Display is roughly twice body, not four times. Nothing is asserted by size, so nothing has to be believed on the strength of it.

**Compressed is not small.** The material we were given sets body at 17px with a display barely above it, which reads as reticence at the cost of comfort. Body moves to 18px on a 60–68 character measure, phones included. Nothing carrying a sentence falls below 18px; the letterspaced labels sit at 14px and never carry one. Restraint is expressed in the ratio between sizes, never in the smallest one.

NOT USED

- A second typeface, anywhere
- Letterspaced or all-capital body copy
- Bold to stress a word inside a sentence; 600 is for labels, lead-ins and named terms
- More than two heading sizes on a page
- Justified text, or a measure over 70 characters

# The one thing a photograph can settle.

## THE PORTRAIT

A reader is deciding whether to spend an hour opposite a stranger. On a site whose argument is that the relationship does most of the work, we think a photograph does something here that writing cannot easily do.

One portrait: daylight, eye level, ordinary clothes, no styling. On About, never the first screen.

## SHOT LIST

|                                                             |                                                               |                                                                 |                                                                                 |                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01                                                          | 02                                                            | 03                                                              | 04                                                                              | 05                                                                                    |
| The portrait — daylight, eye level, conversational distance | The street door on Fisher Street — which entrance to look for | The room from the doorway, as a first visitor sees it, unstaged | One surface — plaster in raking light, captioned with a fact about the building | The Ouse below Lewes in flat light — a place, captioned as one, not water as metaphor |

A working list rather than a requirement — the site should still work if 05 is never taken. Captions state what a thing is; they do not explain what it means.

## NOT PHOTOGRAPHED

Hands around mugs · empty chairs · tissue boxes and candles · pebbles, still water, mist and reeds as metaphor · anything staged to resemble a session · stock images of calm

## OPEN DECISION · RECOMMENDATION

Nothing you have given us includes a photograph of you, and we have assumed nothing. We would recommend one, and it is the recommendation here most worth arguing with. If you would rather not be photographed, say so — declining costs the site a shortcut rather than an argument, and the practical photographs and the writing still carry it.

## LIGHT AND TREATMENT

Daylight from one direction, visible shadow, nothing lit to look warm. Slightly desaturated, no filter, no grade towards cream or sage. Square corners, full column or full bleed. No vignette, no overlay, no text over an image.

## PLACEMENT AND QUANTITY

Five is the ceiling and four is better. Photographs sit between sections, never beside the sentence they illustrate. One landscape only — the material we were given leans on mist and reeds, and a second turns the site into weather.

# What the site has to do about it.

Each requirement follows from a conclusion on an earlier page. If a conclusion changes when you review it, the requirement beside it changes with it.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

DESIGN REQUIREMENT

Your method is subtraction: you take out whatever would make a client perform.

The interface subtracts. No cards, icon sets, testimonials, badges, pop-ups, chat widget or newsletter prompt. Long intervals between sections, and bands that carry a single sentence without apologising for the space.

This reader has been deciding for somewhere between six months and nine years, and is not shopping.

Nothing urgent anywhere: no limited availability, no countdown, no repeated calls to action. One contact action, in the same position on every page, and a page that lets someone stop halfway down without being chased.

Your expertise is real and deliberately unstaged.

Display type no more than twice body size. Experience, registration, supervision and insurance given once as a plain ledger, with no logo row and no badges.

You will not tell anyone how their grief or their divorce is supposed to feel.

Colour carries no mood: one accent, used only for what can be clicked. No tinted grounds beyond ink and paper, and no photograph used to supply an emotion the copy declines to name.

Emotional restraint has to be paid for with practical certainty.

Fee, session length, days, delivery, access, cancellation terms and reply time all published — in the first screen or one click from it, in plain numerals, as content rather than small print.

Unfamiliarity with therapy is a presenting problem, not a frequently asked question.

It gets a page in the main navigation carrying the same weight as the two circumstances, and it opens by refusing the premise rather than by reassuring.

The obstacle at the end is irreversibility, not information.

The action is *arrange a first conversation*, never *book therapy*. The twenty minutes are described in full, including that stopping there is a normal outcome.

# The site, specified.

Written so the design stage does not have to reconstruct the reasoning. Anything not listed here is a decision for design, not a decision that was forgotten.

## Pages

The ten you already work with: Home · About · Therapy · Loss and bereavement · Life changes · For Men · How it works · Fees · Contact · Privacy. Flat, third route landing on Therapy.

## You, on the site

Eighteen years, eleven in hospice work, stated once as a ledger on About. Training in a paragraph, then left. Registration, supervision, insurance and the BACP framework as facts, not logos.

## Limits and crisis

What you will not do, listed plainly. A permanent urgent-help note on Contact, set as content in ink rather than a red band. The services and numbers it names are yours to confirm.

## Navigation

A plain header, ten pages behind a standard menu on small screens. The current page marked with the rust rule and nothing else. No mega-menu, no sticky bar.

## Homepage, in order

The line and three sentences under it · the three routes · you in your own voice, on ink · what an hour contains · the practical ledger · one contact action.

## What an hour contains

On Therapy, in the order the anxious reader asks: what it is like before what it is. Silence is allowed, nothing needs preparing, and *this isn't working* is a usable sentence.

## Confidentiality

The exceptions in full on Privacy, including the unflattering ones: what is written down, where it is kept, for how long, and who could see it. In your voice.

## Motion

None beyond a 150ms colour change on links and focus. No parallax, no fade-in on scroll, no autoplay. Motion here would read as the page performing.

## First screen

The line, the three sentences, and the fee and session length visible without scrolling on a laptop. No image behind text, no overlay, nothing else.

## The two circumstances

Routes, not specialisms. Each opens with a situation rather than a definition, promises no stages or closure, and links sideways rather than to a booking action.

## Contact and reply

One short form — name, email, optional telephone, two lines, a consent box — with two lines is *enough* beside it. The two-working-day reply stated before it is sent.

## Deliberately omitted

Testimonials · ratings · a blog · downloads · newsletter signup · social icons · a booking calendar · live chat · stock photography · the words *book now*.

## Fees

Its own page, opening with why it exists. Reduced places set in the same size as the full fee, the no-form and no-means-test wording kept, alternatives named.

## Practical and access

Fisher Street, second floor, no lift — in body copy on How it works and again on Contact. What to do on arrival, the platform named, days and times stated.

## Mobile

One column, same order, same copy. Ledgers stack into pairs, never a horizontal scroll. Body stays at 18px, and the contact action sits in the flow rather than a sticky bar.

## Accessibility

Focus states visible in rust, links underlined as well as coloured, headings in order, alt text written as description rather than atmosphere, full keyboard operation.

# What was decided.

The conclusions a designer and a writer need, and nothing else from the preceding pages.

## PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

A counsellor of eighteen years who treats time and attention as the working materials, and takes out of the hour anything that would ask a client to perform.

## PHILOSOPHY

The loss does not shrink; what tends to change is how much of a life it takes to carry. Your practice is organised around speech, repeated, to someone unfrightened by it.

## VOICE

Plain, specific, unhurried, dry. Observes and then stops. Occasionally funny, never at the reader's expense. Never argues for therapy.

## IDENTITY IDEA

The name on the same hairline rule as every other section of the site. No symbol.

## VISUAL DIRECTION

Paper and ink, one low rust for actions only. One serif, hierarchy compressed to roughly two to one. Four or five photographs, one a portrait if section 11 is agreed.

The chain, read backwards from any decision on the site: an experienced, unstaged practitioner → competent, private clients wary of performance → permission and practical certainty rather than persuasion → speech may change the weight of a thing, not its size → writing that observes and stops → an interface that subtracts → a reversible first step.

## PEOPLE TO REACH

Adults who are managing, carrying something that has run out of anywhere to be said. A lot of them in their forties, fifties and sixties, and over half of them men.

## CORE MESSAGE · OPEN DECISION

*Somewhere to stop for a while.*

## DESIRED FEELING

That nothing is being asked of you yet.

## WEBSITE PRIORITY

Make the twenty minutes easy to ask for without explaining why, and make stopping there an outcome the site has already blessed.

## THE ONE TEST

**The site must never ask the visitor to be more certain, more articulate or more distressed than they actually are.**

# Does this sound like your practice?

Once you approve it, this Blueprint is the agreed direction for the website. The build then works from these pages, so the time goes into making the site good rather than settling the same questions twice. Deciding the thinking now is what stops design being used to answer strategic questions later.

Read it once quickly and once slowly. Where something is factually wrong, correct it. Where something is right but badly put, say so — that is an equally useful correction. Where you disagree with a recommendation, say what you would want instead, or simply say it is not you, and we will find the version that is.

Two consolidated rounds of revision are included at this stage. Sending your comments together produces a better document and a faster build.

Portfolio note — Stillpoint Therapy and Michael Deane are a fictional practice created by Alexander Watson Studio to demonstrate the Practice Clarity Blueprint. No qualification, registration, membership, testimonial or clinical claim in this document is real, and no client work is represented. This note appears only in portfolio editions.

## WHAT TO REVIEW

- Factual accuracy, and the details still to confirm
- Whether the description sounds like you
- The philosophy, and how firmly it is stated
- Who the site speaks to most directly
- The primary message, and the voice
- The intended client experience
- The central proposition, section 01
- The nameplate, and no symbol
- Colour and typography
- Whether you are photographed, section 11
- The website requirements, section 12
- Anything the site should not imply

## AFTER APPROVAL

Design begins from the direction agreed here, so the website can concentrate on bringing it to life instead of reopening these decisions.

Stillpoint

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